ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 11: **The Thief's Story (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** Hari Singh	Hari narrates.
2	**(d)** fifteen	A teenager.
3	**(a)** small room	A modest home.
4	**(a)** thief	A young thief.
5	**(b)** Ruskin Bond	Ruskin Bond.
6	**(c)** sports contest	Wrestling is a sport.
7	**(d)** writer	He wrote stories.
8	**(c)** trusting	He trusted Hari.
9	**(d)** generous	Describes a noun.
10	**(b)** at a wrestling match	At the wrestling ground.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	The narrator is Hari Singh (1), a young thief (1).	1+1
12	To teach him to read and write (1) so that he could get a better life (1).	1+1
13	He put it back under the mattress (1) without waking Anil (1).	1+1
14	Anil is a young writer (1) who befriends and employs Hari (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Hari wanted Anil's money (1). He thought Anil was easy to fool (1). He pretended to be a friend (1).	1+1+1
16	A small town (1). Anil's room (1). The railway station (1).	1+1+1
17	stole (1), ran (1), came (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He gave him food (1). He gave him a job (1). He promised to teach him (1).	1+1+1
18	The story is told by a thief (1). It shows his life (1). It shows his change (1).	1+1+1
	OR: thieves (1), knives (1), stories (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Hari Singh is a fifteen-year-old thief (1). He plans to rob Anil (1). He steals the money but feels guilty (1). He returns it (1). He decides to learn (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Address and date (1). Salutation (1). Thanks for kindness (1). Promise to study (1). Closing and name (1).	2+2+1
20	Anil is a young writer (1). He is kind and trusting (1). He gives Hari a job (1). He promises to teach him (1). He changes Hari's life (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Anil was friendly (1). He gave food and work (1). He did not suspect him (1). He offered lessons (1). His kindness reformed Hari (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Hari Singh is a student; he is a **fifteen-year-old thief**, narrating in the first person, who tries to rob the writer Anil.
- Mixing Anil's response: he offers Hari **food, work and lessons**, and when Hari returns the notes Anil quietly shows he knows, without exposing him.
- Forgetting the notes episode: Hari puts the notes back under Anil's mattress; *this* is the moral turning point of the story.
- Treating money as Hari's only motive; he also wants to become a **respected, educated man**, which draws him to Anil.
- Saying Anil caught him and called the police; the story ends in **trust**, with Anil handing him a wet fifty-rupee note.
- Spelling slips: *Ruskin Bond, thief, Anil, wrestler, mattress*.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 11: **The Thief's Story (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** thief	A thief steals.
2	**(b)** suspected	He did not suspect him.
3	**(b)** cook	Hari became cook.
4	**(d)** doubt	Doubt.
5	**(b)** regret	To feel sorry.
6	**(b)** money	He aimed to rob him.
7	**(b)** change a person	It reforms.
8	**(a)** conscience	conscience.
9	**(a)** under the mattress	It was hidden under the mattress.
10	**(d)** money	Money is a thing.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He stole Anil's money (1) kept under the mattress (1).	1+1
12	With kindness (1) and trust (1).	1+1
13	At a wrestling match (1) in the town (1).	1+1
14	To the railway station (1) to catch a train (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	He took the money (1). He went to the railway station (1). He later returned it (1).	1+1+1
16	He remembered Anil's kindness (1). He felt ashamed (1). He wanted to study (1).	1+1+1
17	He gave him a meal (1). He welcomed him home (1). He offered a job (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Anil trusted him (1). He had stolen from his friend (1). He wished to learn (1).	1+1+1
18	Trust changes people (1). Thieves can reform (1). Education is valuable (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Anil did not doubt him (1). Hari was used to suspicion (1). He saw real kindness (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Hari meets Anil (1). He becomes his cook (1). He steals the money (1). He feels guilty and returns it (1). Anil will teach him (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Opening line (1). Honest people are trusted (1). Example from the story (1). Dishonesty brings guilt (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	Anil trusted him (1). Hari felt ashamed (1). He wanted to learn (1). He did not want to lose a friend (1). His conscience woke (1).	2+2+1
	OR: At first he is a cunning thief (1). He plans to rob Anil (1). He feels guilt (1). He returns the money (1). He becomes hopeful (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Hari Singh is a student; he is a **fifteen-year-old thief**, narrating in the first person, who tries to rob the writer Anil.
- Mixing Anil's response: he offers Hari **food, work and lessons**, and when Hari returns the notes Anil quietly shows he knows, without exposing him.
- Forgetting the notes episode: Hari puts the notes back under Anil's mattress; *this* is the moral turning point of the story.
- Treating money as Hari's only motive; he also wants to become a **respected, educated man**, which draws him to Anil.
- Saying Anil caught him and called the police; the story ends in **trust**, with Anil handing him a wet fifty-rupee note.
- Spelling slips: *Ruskin Bond, thief, Anil, wrestler, mattress*.

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MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 11: **The Thief's Story (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** quietly	He crept in.
2	**(d)** railway station	He wanted a train.
3	**(a)** stole	Steal - stole - stolen.
4	**(a)** unaware of the theft	He never learned of it.
5	**(d)** returned it	He put it back.
6	**(a)** thieves	Irregular plural.
7	**(b)** dishonest	Dishonest.
8	**(b)** reading and writing	Education.
9	**(d)** guilty	He felt guilt.
10	**(d)** open a new life	A path to a better life.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He is trusting (1) and generous (1).	1+1
12	He worked as Anil's cook (1) and lived in his house (1).	1+1
13	He felt guilty (1) and remembered Anil's trust (1).	1+1
14	Trust can change a person (1) and education opens new doors (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Anil is a writer (1). He is kind (1). He trusts people (1).	1+1+1
16	Gullible - easily fooled (1). Remorse - deep regret (1). Conscience - inner sense of right and wrong (1).	1+1+1
17	He crept into the room (1). Anil was asleep (1). He put the money under the mattress (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Hari is a young thief (1). He is clever (1). He changes at the end (1).	1+1+1
18	Any three correct sentences (1 each).	1+1+1
	OR: Greed (1). Guilt (1). Hope (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Kindness and trust can change people (1). Everyone deserves a second chance (1). Education helps (1). Crime is not the answer (1). Honesty is best (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Date (1). Joy at Hari's willingness (1). Plan for lessons (1). Feeling about trust (1). Closing line (1).	2+2+1
20	Hari reaches the station with the money (1). He sits and waits for a train (1). He thinks of Anil (1). He feels guilty (1). He decides to go back (1).	2+2+1
	OR: He knows his own thoughts (1). We see his guilt (1). We understand his past (1). We sympathise with him (1). His honest voice makes it real (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

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MASTERMIND